

Information Security Policy

Introduction and Scope

This Information Security Policy establishes the framework for protecting sensitive data and assets across our global operations. It applies to all employees, contractors, and third parties handling ad-hoc services, research data, and business consulting in South Africa, the UK, US, Nigeria, Lesotho, Swaziland and United Arab Countries.

Objective and Scope

The primary objective of this policy is to safeguard the Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability (CIA) triad of our corporate and client data.

- **Applicability:** This policy governs all business units, including ad-hoc project delivery, empirical research services, and strategic consulting.
- **Jurisdictional Compliance:** Operations must align with regional data protection laws: South Africa (POPIA), the EU/UK (GDPR), the US (regulated by state and federal guidelines), Nigeria (NDPA), Lesotho (Data Protection Act), and the UAE (UAE Data Protection Law).

Data Classification and Handling

We process personal data based on different legal grounds depending on the applicable jurisdiction (e.g., GDPR in the UK, POPIA in South Africa, and the NDPA in Nigeria). We rely on the following lawful bases:

Given the sensitive nature of business consulting and research, all information will be classified and handled according to its sensitivity level:

- **Public:** Information approved for general release (e.g., published white papers, marketing materials).
- **Internal:** Information for internal use only. Unauthorized disclosure will not cause significant business harm but should remain within the company.
- **Confidential:** Highly sensitive data, including client financial projections, intellectual property, unreleased research data, and employee records.
- **Handling Rules:** Confidential data will be encrypted both at rest and in transit. Physical documents will be locked away when not in use.

Client and Vendor Management

Third-party and client data security is paramount.

- Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs): All consultants and researchers must sign an NDA before engaging with any client data.
- Third-Party Risk: Vendors and subcontractors must be vetted to ensure they maintain information security practices that meet or exceed our baseline requirements.